



1893

ART NOUVEAU ARRIVES

Reacting against the fussiness of Victorian decoration, European architects and designers developed a style known as Art Nouveau – literally New Art. It was characterized by flowing organic lines, natural forms, and modern materials. Architects such as Belgian Victor Horta, who designed the Hotel Tassel, popularized the style. Art Nouveau featured at the 1900 International Exhibition in Paris.

▷ Hotel Tassel, Brussels, Belgium



1893 France expands colonial rule over much of West Africa

1894

1892 Homer Plessy, a Louisiana Creole, challenges discriminatory US “Jim Crow” laws by sitting in a whites-only carriage

1894 Christian Armenians are massacred when they demand reforms within the Ottoman Empire



1848-1943
KATE SHEPPARD

Born in Liverpool, Sheppard moved to New Zealand in her early twenties. Committed to women's rights, she campaigned strenuously for the vote, crisscrossing the country, lobbying, and organizing petitions.



◁ Memorial shows Kate Sheppard, Meri Te Tai Mangakahia, and other campaigners

1893

NEW ZEALAND WOMEN WIN THE VOTE

In September 1893, women in New Zealand became the first to win the right to vote in parliamentary elections. Their success followed a long campaign headed by women such as Kate Sheppard who presented petitions to parliament, until finally the law was passed giving white and Maori women voting rights. New Zealand women could not, however, stand for parliament until 1919.